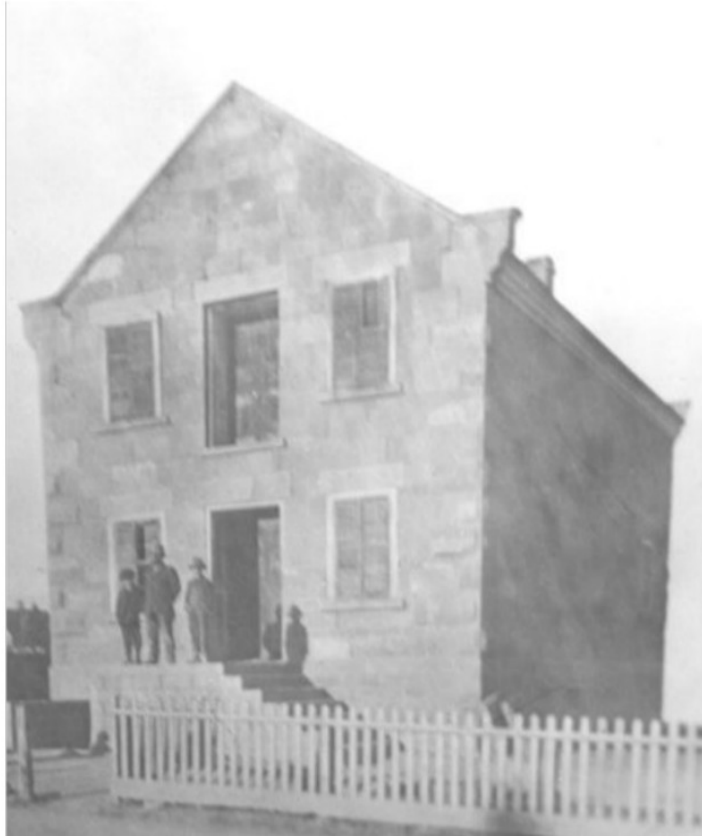




CEDAR CITY BISHOP'S TITHING OFFICE

Built in 1856

Location: 198 North Main

January 22, 1873: Francis Webster, Mayor. "City Council conferred with Bishop Henry Lunt who agreed to rent the small apartment in the Tithing Office cellar for a City Prison." (From Mayors of Cedar City, written by Evelyn K. and York F. Jones)



CHAPTER XVIII

CIVIL WAR TIMES

1861 – 1865

The year 1861 was one of the most distressing years America had ever seen since becoming an independent nation. Five states seceded from the union in January – Mississippi, Georgia, Alabama, Louisiana, and Florida. Texas seceded in February followed by North Carolina, Tennessee, Arkansas, Virginia and part of Missouri. As the rumble of war grew, the Pony Express raced the reports to the West. On the evening of April 4, 1861, a day that saw rain, hail, and snow fall in Salt Lake City, the "Pony" roared into the city with ominous news about the firing by the south on Fort Sumpter. It was the powder keg that touched off the war.

In the late 1850's, a method of communication called the Pony Express was established. This introduced epochal changes to the reading habits of Utah's people, pushing out during the war in the States into new frontiers. This plan brought the news to the isolated towns in parts of Utah and also brought the news, which helped expand the newspaper, *Deseret News*, so that it could keep the people of Utah informed. The plan was to run a light letter mail service

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across the continent by solitary horsemen carrying fifteen pounds of letters. The charge to send this mail was \$5 per one-half ounce. Stations were located about twenty-four miles apart. As his day's ride, each rider was required to span three stations at the rate of eight miles an hour. The Pony Express service was popular in Utah and a number of young Mormon men were among the most successful and fearless of the riders.¹ Among the newspapers of the land, there were widely varying shades of opinion regarding secession when the Civil War broke out. The *Deseret News*, while reaffirming its love of "truth and liberty" that came through the Declaration of Independence and the Constitution, did not vigorously wave the banner of either side. Rather, its attitude was one of thankfulness that its people were in the tops of the mountains away from the holocaust.

During the Civil War many people expected the Mormons to join the Confederacy. The L.D.S. people, however, remained firmly loyal to the Constitution and the Union, but they did not send soldiers to participate in the fighting. The only response that was made was to meet Abraham Lincoln's request to Brigham Young for a company of cavalry to protect the mail route through Wyoming. This ended in 1862 when Camp Douglas was built in Salt Lake City and Colonel Patrick Connor and the Third California Volunteers took over the postal guard duty from the Mormons.

By asking Brigham Young for guards for the mail route, Lincoln recognized the State of Deseret and its leaders as a reality. This occurred despite the fact that Utah's applications for statehood continued to be denied in the growing crusade against polygamy. Lincoln told a visitor from Utah that the Mormons were like the logs he learned to plow around as a youth clearing timber, "too hard to split, too wet to burn, and too heavy to move," and added, "You go back and tell Brigham Young that if he will let me alone I will let him alone." And generally that is what Lincoln did.²

At the end of 1861, Wilford Woodruff wrote a review of the year, part of which follows:

Eleven of the States have seceded. This has brought a terrible war upon the country, bringing upon the

battlefield more than a million men and a debt of millions of dollars and thousands of lives. The state of Missouri, where the saints have received their persecutions, is now the great battlefield of the west. It is now man against man and neighbor against neighbor, and this is only the beginning of the trouble.³

The same year that the Civil War started with the firing on Fort Sumpter, Henry and Mary Ann became the parents of a second child, another girl, which they named Ellen Eva Lunt. She was born February 7, 1861, and was named after Henry's first wife.

Immigration to the Great Basin continued in spite of the war. The L.D.S. Church devised an immigration plan which took place in April of each year whereby wagons carrying flour and provisions were sent east to pick up saints immigrating west. As an example, during 1862, the second year of the plan, 262 wagons with 293 men and 2,880 oxen were sent. There was a total of 143,315 pounds of flour sent with them.⁴ The return of wagon trains brought thousands of additional saints to the mountain west. The Church wards and branches in each of the towns were requested to furnish "outfits" to keep this immigration system running. John D. Lee, who was the Presiding Elder in Harmony, outlined the following interesting details in his journal concerning this:

March 16, 1863, 8 o'clock, Harmony, Utah: A messenger arrived with a letter from Orson Pratt and Erastus Snow requesting the Harmony Branch to furnish three outfits of wagons, with four yoke of cattle to each, to go down to Florence, Nebraska and assist in bringing out the poor saints. Each wagon was to be outfitted for a six-month journey, and each team carried 1000 lbs. of flour to feed the poor on the road.

The "Immigration Plan" turned out to be very successful. This plan continued until the Transcontinental Railroad was completed in

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1869. David D. Bulloch of Cedar City made several such trips across the plains. He normally ran a freighting business, hauling supplies to Austin, Nevada. This was before the road opened from California over the Sierra Nevada Mountains, which allowed freight to be brought in from the west coast. Bulloch received \$18 per hundred pounds of flour which amounted to a total of \$900 for a 5000-pound load. In the spring of 1868, after returning from taking a load of flour to Austin, he recorded the following in his journal:

It was 9 o'clock at night when I got home. Before I got out of bed the next morning, Bishop Henry Lunt and Brothers Arthur and Webster came to see if I would go back after emigrants again. I asked them if there was no one else in town who could go, I had been across twice, once for the poor, and that I could do well to go to Austin with freight. They said no one had mule teams but Andrew Corry and me--that if I would go they would promise me that the Lord would bless me. After talking for some time, I promised them that I would go. They said I would have to be ready, as the company would leave in three days. I was ready at the appointed time. They told me I should be blessed and should never rue it, and their words came true. Just after my return from Austin, three St. George teams took loads out there and did well with them. Coming home, I was told, they bored a hole in a two-inch piece of lumber and put their gold in this piece of lumber. Coming home, three men attacked them and made them hold up their hands, went through their pockets, but, not finding the amount they knew they had, they asked where the rest was. The St. George men said that was all they had when they were told to tell where it was hidden. So the robbers tied a rope around their thumbs and, putting a stick in it, twisted the rope till the men were forced to tell them where the money was. One of the

robbers had seen the money paid over to the men. They took every dollar and then asked if they knew where Dave Bulloch was. Thus, I was blessed to be on my way to help the Saints.⁵

At a public meeting held in Cedar City on January 8, 1861, Samuel Leigh, John M. Higbee and Isaac C. Haight were appointed as a committee to build a Social Hall. The building was erected that year (100 East and 75 North). Before this, only a school room had been utilized for meeting purposes. The people started tearing down the old meeting house in the Old Fort. Counselor Morris moved to Salt Lake City in the spring of 1861 and, in his place, Samuel Leigh was appointed First Counselor to Bishop Henry Lunt.⁶

A Seventies Conference was held in Cedar City, March 2 and 3, 1861, and the following account was published in the *Deseret News*:

The Seventies in Iron County held their Quarterly Conference at Cedar City, Iron County, commencing on Saturday the 2nd of March. The conference was addressed by Elders George Corry, Joseph Hunter, Gabriel Dana, James Simpkins, R. R. Birkbeck, T. W. Spiking, J. V. Adams, Christopher Jacobs of Toquerville, John Morris and Bishop Henry Lunt.

Sunday the 3rd at 11 a.m.: Bishop Lunt spoke of the improvement observable of late in the Quorum meetings at Iron County and made some appropriate remarks in relation to the duties of the elders and of all the Saints.

President Brigham Young and party visited Cedar City in the spring of 1861. They had been in Parowan and left there Thursday morning May 30. They proceeded to Cedar City where they arrived at noon. The Saints assembled at 4 o'clock p.m. in the Social Hall and were addressed by President Young followed by President Daniel H. Wells and Elders Wilford Woodruff and John Taylor. Young and his party partook of a dinner at the Social Hall on May 31.⁷

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Although the early settlers of Utah had placed more emphasis on celebrating the 24th rather than the 4th of July, Independence Day had gained in significance. July 4, 1861, brought with it an enthusiastic celebration throughout the Utah Territory, in which the Saints always took delight. Wilford Woodruff declared it was the greatest celebration he ever witnessed in Salt Lake City. On Sunday July 21st, Woodruff recorded some of the remarks from a speech given by Brigham Young as follows:

Brigham Young declared, 'The Lord will not permit me or any other man to lead this people astray. If the leaders do wrong, the Lord will take them away.' President Young was severe in his denunciation of the liquor traffic, saying, 'Any man who will make whiskey to sell would sell the Kingdom of God for a picayune. I despise the whisky maker more than I do the thieves, and I have no use for either. Harlots and publicans will enter the Kingdom of God before the whisky dealer. Cursed is he that putteth the cup to his brother's lips.'

In later years the Council of the Presidency and Twelve resolved that the liquor dealers must repent and forsake their business or lose their standing in the Church. The conference of October 6th 1861 was characterized by the plans then discussed for the development of the cotton industry in Southern Utah.⁸

All the major movable parts were stripped from the Iron Works and taken to the new settlement of St. George (named after George A. Smith) to help in the establishment of the Cotton Mission. Prior to this time there was an auction of equipment and goods on December 20, 1861. Henry was among 45 bidders for everything from anvils to log chains and charcoal. He purchased some timber, poles, piping, iron bars, a house, sleepers and 32 pounds of brads, paying a total of \$46.87 for these articles. The remainder of the company's holdings, not removed or auctioned, such as cog wheels, shafting, cast pedestals

and coke, were sold directly to individuals.⁹

In April 1862, in spite of the Civil War and all the national turmoil, Justice Morrill of Vermont introduced the first Congressional Bill against the practice of polygamy into the House of Representatives. This bill which was designed to punish and prevent the practice of polygamy in the territories of the United States made the contracting of a plural marriage punishable by a fine of \$500 or imprisonment for a term of five years, or both. The Anti-bigamy Act further provided that no religious corporation could hold real estate in any of the territories of a value in excess of \$50,000. The bill was signed by President Lincoln on July 8, 1862.¹⁰

That same spring, on March 22, 1862, Henry and his family attended conference in Salt Lake City. Henry and Mary Ann's oldest child, Henrietta, who was four years old was sealed to them. This was necessary because, when she was born, Mary Ann had not yet been through the Endowment House. On January 25, 1863, Henry and Mary Ann finally were blessed with a son. Being the first boy they named him Henry after his father, and he was given the middle name of Whittaker, Henry's first wife's maiden name. This was in honor of Ellen since she was unable to have children of her own.

Isaac C. Haight wrote in his journal on December 29, 1862 that invited guests assembled at 11 a.m. on Christmas Day at the new brick home of Henry Lunt. Haight dedicated the new home.¹¹

The following year while attending another conference in Salt Lake City, Henry was married and sealed to his third wife, Ann Creswell Gower, on April 11, 1863. She was nineteen years old, having been born October 10, 1843. The following is a short history of Ann Gower by one of her sons, Thomas Amos Lunt:

My mother's father, Thomas Gower, one of the better class of English blood, was an iron foundry man by trade, having been employed as an overseer of a large force of men in an iron foundry in Stratsford, England prior to his coming to America. His wife, Jane Cresswell Gower, also of the upper class of English lineage, had some brothers who were

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commissioned officers in the British Army. When the Gospel message happened to reach the ears of grandfather and grandmother Gower, it found such a responsive chord in their hearts that the spirit of the gathering to Zion seized them and they followed their impulse to come to America. It so happened that they came aboard the same ship that my father did. The young Henry Lunt likely little dreamed then that the six-year-old child, the oldest of the three children in the Gower family, would one day become his wife.

Grandfather Gower, instead of going to Council Bluffs as did my father, left the steamer at St. Louis, Missouri where he secured employment at his accustomed line of occupation in an iron foundry, being placed in charge of a group of men because of his broad experience in foundry work. He continued to hold his job here for a period of five years, thus managing to save enough means to outfit himself and family with clothes, a grub stake, ox team wagon, and an assortment of tools for his long-contemplated trek west. But, soon after his arrival at St. Louis, an epidemic of cholera broke out claiming many victims. Among them was Grandmother Gower and her two younger children which left Grandfather Gower a widower with only his little Ann.

Having to be at his post early and late, he was obliged to leave his motherless child in the care of neighbors. The lonely little girl would often stray away in search of her missing mother, being too young to realize that her dear mother had gone beyond mortal reach. Within about two years Grandfather met a young widow by the name of Martha Tidswell. She, too, was a convert to the Mormon faith, and it appeared that a match would be of mutual benefit to the two. Be it said though that the love of a real mother could never be replaced.

Grandfather's team for the long journey to the valley of the Great Salt Lake consisted of a yoke of oxen and cows. The company that they joined was known as the Independent Immigration Company as each family owned its own outfit independent of the Church's aid, which so many of the newcomers of those days were obliged to avail themselves of. Their pilgrimage was beset with many perils incident to those days. Ann was, by this time, eleven years of age and able to walk a good share of the distance, as the children of that time were compelled to do. One day, while trailing some distance behind the rear wagon of the train, she was prompted to look behind her and was startled to discover an Indian making ready to spring upon her. By exerting all the energy possible, she managed to escape the redman's grasp.

On arriving at Salt Lake City, Grandfather Gower located in the West Jordan district where he set to work at once to build himself a home and make preparations to give his major attentions to farming. But he received a call from President Young to go to Cedar City and assist in the manufacture of iron. He promptly responded to this call. He and John P. Jones, both men of years of experience in the foundry work, played important roles in the local iron works.

My parents (Henry Lunt and Ann C. Gower) were married in the Endowment House in Salt Lake City by the late Daniel H. Wells on April 11, 1863. I have never learned much regarding their courtship so will have to omit that. However, I will mention in passing that many such weddings were of the short order. There was little hanging on the gate until the wee hours. My mother was much older than her father's other children [by his second wife] and she was required to help in the fields and with other heavy work, even until she was nearly grown. Thus, she was

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deprived of many social affairs and, in a general way, her girlhood days were spent in heavy toil and she received a scant part of what meager schooling those days had to offer.¹²

Henry had been Mayor of Cedar City since the spring of 1861. His term followed his close friend's, Isaac C. Haight, which made Henry the second mayor of Cedar City. This meant that he was Bishop of the Cedar Ward, Cedar Stake President and Mayor of Cedar City at the same time as well as keeping up his farm, being a merchant and fulfilling his family obligations. The Cedar Stake of Zion included Cedar Ward, Harmony, Johnson's Fort (Elk Horn or Enoch), Hamilton Fort and Kanarra. It was necessary to be a citizen in order to qualify to hold a public office. The records of the Second District Court in Beaver, Utah Territory index book listed a "Certificate of Naturalization" for Henry Lunt. A Letter sent from Parowan to inform the Territorial Government of this election is as follows:

Parowan, February 21, 1863: to Secretary, Frank Fuller: I embrace the opportunity to notify you that, on the second Monday of this month, Henry Lunt was duly elected Mayor, and James Whittaker and Samuel Leigh, Aldermen, for Cedar City. Also, on the same day, William S. Warren was elected Mayor for Parowan. Yours respectfully, Richard Benson, Clerk--County Court, Iron County.¹³

The election that took place on March 23, 1865, resulted in Henry continuing as Mayor for two more years. His Aldermen were John M. Higbee and Christopher J. Arthur. Henry didn't run for the election in 1867, and John M. Higbee became the third Mayor after Henry Lunt. The City Council roll call in the city minutes dated February 1867 listed the following: Henry Lunt--Mayor, James Whittaker--Alderman, Samuel Leigh--Alderman, C. J. Arthur--Councillor and George Hunter--Councillor.¹⁴

As a result of the Mountain Meadows tragedy, the Harmony Ward minute book contained the following concerning John D. Lee:

March 5, 1864: Bishop Lunt was present. John D. Lee tendered his resignation as President of the Branch [Harmony] because of much dissatisfaction among the people toward him. Elder James H. Imlay was selected and set apart to succeed him as (Branch) President. Bishop Henry Lunt set Mr. Imlay apart.¹⁵

Three days before Henry was in Harmony his third wife, Ann Gower Lunt, had her first child, a girl, born March 3, 1864. They named her Jane Gower Lunt. Later in the year on November 8, 1864, Mary Ann, Henry's second wife, had her fourth child which was a boy. They named him Randle Wilson Lunt.

Living in the tiny settlement of Harmony was not easy. John D. Lee wrote about an experience which had a great effect on him, It was after a raging winter storm had damaged his adobe house, "Bishop Lunt, Brother Higbee and Brother Haight came during the storm and were afraid to stay overnight--went to Kanarra, but the prospect was not much better. Another night of gloom and darkness." The storm which Lee wrote about continued and two of his children were killed when a section of wall crashed through the upstairs floor where they were asleep in their beds.¹⁶

The Church was anxious to see the "Cotton Mission" succeed. They started producing cotton, but problems caused delays. Despite the fact that cotton and other desirables were produced, the colony was not on a sure economic footing. It was clear that the mission would not be a success until a factory was constructed which could produce quality cotton goods. Some cotton was made up into clothing in the region, some was sold in Salt Lake City in exchange for grain and supplies, some was freighted to the Missouri River, but the bulk of it could not be disposed of because of the lack of a factory. There was a small cotton mill in Parowan which was built at the specific request of Brigham Young. By September it was reported to be making thirty-five pounds of serviceable yarn per day. The following

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article appeared in the *Deseret News* on Wednesday, April 16, 1863:

Parowan Cotton Factory--The cotton mill at Parowan, owned by Ebenezer Hanks, is so far completed as to be doing tolerable good work, with a fair prospect that it will be a success, satisfactory both to the proprietor and the public. Only 72 spindles have yet been put in motion, but others will be ere long. The establishment is not very extensive but, when put in complete working order, may be expected to furnish a market for some considerable portion of the cotton that was grown in Washington County last season. As the cotton growing business in the southern part of the state is expected to be greatly increased, other and more extensive mills will, of course, be erected at no distant day.

Other settlements made arrangements for machinery to assist in working up the cotton on a local basis. A group of men in Cedar City decided to build a factory. In March 1863 they recorded:

Constitution of the Cedar City cotton Manufacturing Association: Article 1--We the undersigned do hereby unite ourselves in a company to be known as the Cedar City Cotton Manufacturing Association. Article 2--The design of said company is to procure machinery and material necessary to erect a cotton factory to card, spin and weave cotton into fabric.

There were fourteen "articles" detailing the plan to start this factory and there were twenty-one shareholders. They bought a total of fifty shares between them. Henry Lunt was the first name listed on the Stock Holders list. He bought a total of three shares. Many of the men just had one share. Some had two or three. There was one man, Joseph Hunter, who purchased twelve, and another, James Bulloch, who had eight.¹⁷ Under the date of March 15, 1865, Bishop Henry

Lunt wrote the following which was published in the *Deseret News*:

After a long and tedious winter of four months duration, the weather has moderated and the deep snows of winter are disappearing in Little Salt Lake Valley, at which the inhabitants rejoice much. If the fine weather continues, the farmers intend to begin putting in grain next week. As in all other parts of the Territory, the prospects for an abundance of water for irrigation were never so good before. Some cattle have died on the range, and it is feared that a great many horses have perished on the range near Kanarra; some few have been found dead. Others have been brought in from the mountains as mere skeletons and, of course, soon afterwards died. Almost everything in the shape of horse or cattle feed around Cedar is consumed. A number of sheep and nearly all the young lambs have died, teaching the inhabitants a lesson to provide better for their stock in years to come. The health of the people is good and feelings of peace and harmonies predominate in the settlement.

On May 24, 1865, another article written by Henry Lunt was published in the *Deseret News*, which was taken from a letter to George A. Smith. The article contained news about the immense amount of work the farmers had done, making a canal to convey the water to the south side of the new survey to distribute the water for irrigation purposes. Part of the letter is as follows:

Brother Lunt says that he has planted an orchard of 300 trees, all choice selections of fruit, and he further says that, although it has for years been the generally received opinion that fruit could not be raised in that locality, he is persuaded to the contrary and, as an encouragement, there were to be seen apple, peach, plum and cherry trees in blossom. The

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weather had suddenly become very warm and the melting snow was pouring down Coal Creek in torrents, the stream having already reached a higher point than ever known before. All the dams previously built across the creek for irrigation purposes had been swept away on the 30th of this month, and a strong force of men were striving to control and direct the current of the stream. Notwithstanding much land is being flooded, Brother Lunt seems to take consolation in the assurance that the bottoms will, after the high water subsides, yield a plentiful crop of wire grass. It is so warm that the thermometer is ranging at July instead of May figures.

In September 1865, President Brigham Young and party visited southern Utah. They held two meetings at Cedar City on September 22. The public hall was festooned with flowers and green boughs for this occasion. Bishop Lunt and the people of Cedar were unremitting in their endeavors to show a hearty welcome to the President and his traveling companions. They opened their homes to the group as well. The meetings were addressed by Elders Wilford Woodruff, George A. Smith, Lorenzo Snow, Ezra T. Benson, Franklin D. Richards and President Young. After the afternoon meeting, they left for Parowan.¹⁸

After four years, the Civil War ended in April 1865, with the surrender of General Lee at Appomattox on April 9 and of General Johnston at Greensboro on April 26. The war resulted in the preservation of the Union, the abolition of slavery and many important social and economic changes.

A considerable quantity of wire that had been used by the military for telegraphic communications systems became available. This was purchased by the Church for the purpose of building a telegraph system from Salt Lake City to the southern communities. A special conference was called in Salt Lake City on April 10, 1865, to vote on the feasibility of erecting a telegraph line through the settlements of Utah. Each family in Iron County was assessed nine poles, to be used in the construction of the telegraph line. The first telegraph

headquarters was in the Church Tithing Office located on Main Street. After a short time the telegraph office was moved into the parlor of the Henry Lunt home on Lincoln Avenue and First East which was known as the Lunt Hotel and Stage Stop. Originally the Lunt address was Spring Avenue and High Street.¹⁹

The Deseret Telegraph Line was completed as far as St. George on January 1, 1867. Josiah Rogerson was sent from Beaver to Cedar City to instruct the first group in telegraphy. Ellen Lunt, Alice B. Bulloch, Mary C. Corlett and Henrietta Lunt took turns as operators. Maude Lunt was the last of the old Deseret Telegraph Company operators. The company was eventually taken over by Western Union.

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2. Eugene England, *Brother Brigham* (Salt Lake City, Utah: Publishers Press, 1980), Page 187.
3. Matthias F. Cowley, *Wilford Woodruff*, (Salt Lake City, Utah: Bookcraft, 1964), p. 419.
4. B. H. Roberts, *op. cit.*, Vol. 5, p. 109.
5. David Bulloch, *Our Pioneer Heritage*, "Recollections of David Bulloch," (Cedar City, Utah: Daughters of The Utah Pioneers), Iron County Library, p. 224.
6. J. Phillip Hanks, *History of Parowan Stake*, (Cedar City, Utah: 1980) L.D.S. Institute, Cedar City, Utah. p. 26.
7. *Deseret News*, (Salt Lake City, Utah: May 30, 1861).
8. Matthias F. Cowley, *op. cit.*, p. 418.
9. "Iron Works Log Book," D.U.P., Cedar City Post Office Bldg., p. 547.
10. Andrew L. Neff, *Histoy of Utah*, (Salt Lake City, Utah: Deseret News Press, 1940), p. 866.
11. Isaac C. Haight, "Issac C. Haight Journal," S.U.U. Special Collections Library, Cedar City, Utah.
12. Thomas Amos Lunt, "Thomas Amos Lunt Journal," From Zina Rigby, Cedar City, Utah, p. 2.
13. From Utah State Archives, TE-3.2, Dated 1863, Salt Lake City, Utah.
14. *Ibid.*
15. J. Phillip Hanks, *op. cit.*, p. 6.
16. John D. Lee, "John D. Lee Journal," S.U.U. Special Collections Library, Cedar City, Utah.
17. "Cotton Manufacturing Association Minutes," 1863, S.U.U. Special Collections Library, Cedar City, Utah.
18. Andrew Jenson *L.D.S. Journal History*, May 24, 1865, *Deseret News*.
19. J. Phillip Hanks, *op. cit.*, p. 3.